



DIY



The best way to shoot a UFO video is to take a video camera with a powerful zoom lens and watch the skies with unending vigil

Make your own UFO video

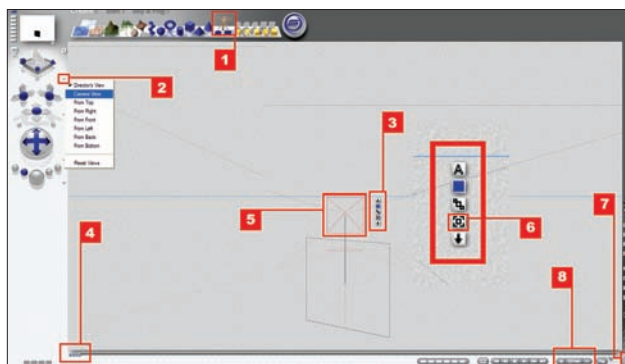
Whether you want to spice up your YouTube channel, or startle your friends with alien activity in the neighbourhood, we show you how to create your own UFO video.

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We will be using Bryce 5.5 to create a UFO video using a single photograph and a model of a UFO.

Importing the background image into Bryce is the first step. Click on the Vitruvian man icon in the objects ribbon (1). A window will open up with an image texture. Click on one of the empty boxes, navigate through the file system and select the background image. A skyline is preferable, but any photograph of a building with an amount of clear sky will do. Next, change the view (2). By default, the director's view is selected. What we will be doing is use the camera to track the picture, so that the viewpoint of the camera is aligned to the centre of the image, no matter how the camera moves. Click on the camera (5) to get a view of the Camera Properties box (3). Click on the tracking icon (6) and drag the thin line to the image you have imported. Now, change the view to the camera view (2), and move the view till your camera is in front of the image. Switch back to the director's view.

Now you will need a UFO. A variety of UFO models are available for free on the internet. Download a 3DS or OBJ file, as these are the most common. You can also use an image with a transparency, if a



The Bryce 5.5 interface

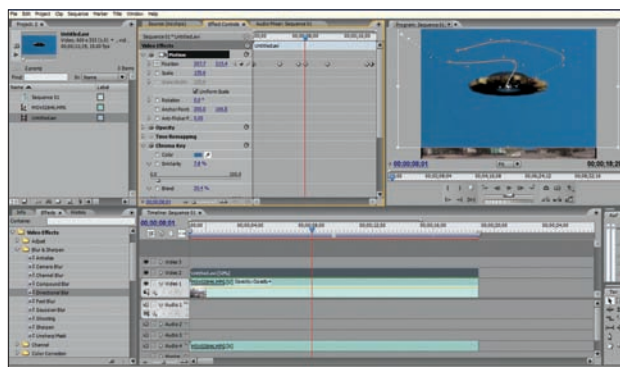
model is not for you. We created a simple UFO by flattening a sphere.

Position the UFO between the camera and the plane of the image. Make the UFO really small. Go to **File > Render** to get a preview of how the image will appear. Make sure you have selected the camera view. Now we will animate the UFO, and give it some movement. Drag the time-line slider (4), till you see about 10 seconds on the bar. This is the length of the video. Keep the video less than a minute, to save on the resources. The longer a UFO video, the more unbelievable it will be. To toggle the animation menu, click on view toggle (7). Click on the UFO, click on the (+) icon in the key-frame menu (8). This creates the first key-frame of the object, the initial position at the beginning of the animation. Now click on the time-line slider (4), and drag it to about 3 seconds. Click on the add key-frame button again, and move the UFO to a slightly different position, rotating if you want. Repeat this process for the entire duration of the animation. Also, assign slight jerks and shakes to the camera itself from the director's view. This will make it look like the camera was handheld, and the shooting was happening in real-time, although you are using an image. Since you have tracked the image, the image will stay within the view of the camera. You can click on the animation

menu, and select **Auto Key** as an alternative. This will allow you to use the slider and make changes directly to the key frames, without having to manually add each key frame.

Now we will move on to a slightly more advanced operation, one of superimposing a UFO onto another video. Go to your terrace and shoot a video of the skyline. Try to get moving objects like vehicles, birds and people. Next, use a UFO model in Bryce. Delete the ground, make the sky a plain colour using the **Sky & Fog** menu, and track the UFO with the camera. The background colour has to be different from the colour given to the object. We used blue as the background, with a modified gear preset from the object menu as our UFO. Now key frame the animation to rotate the UFO, but don't move this around the screen. Export this animation.

We will be using a video-editing software called Adobe Premiere Pro but you can also use previous versions of the software. The technique we will be implementing is called "blue-screening" or "green-screening" which is basically removing a particular colour from the video. Import the video you have shot, then the animation you rendered. Place the video on one track, and place the animation on the track above it. Now make the



Setting motion paths

UFO video layer really small. Select the Chroma key filter from the Video Effects menu, and select the background colour of the rendered animation. Tweak the similarity and blend sliders till none of the background is visible. You will also need to add a blur filter. Use either the Gaussian, Motion, or Camera blur filters or a combination of these.

Next, select the Motion effect in the Effect Controls tab, and assign key frames to the video. Drag the animation around the screen to create a path of movement over the video you have shot. Make sure you synchronise any movement in the camera with movements in the animation. This is the part where you need to sit down and fine-tune movements. The more time you spend in this phase, the better your results will be.

Most UFO videos do not need the surroundings, and are shot at night. These are relatively easy to manipulate, but the surroundings give an amount of realism to the video. Try superimposing UFOs on flight videos for better effect. An "authentic" video should have plenty of jerks and shakes. UFOs are also characterised by rapid and sudden movements. You can also try making them disappear and appear. Happy hoaxing! ■

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